

Core Task

Introduction

This semester we will again be using an Inquiry based model.

This has several advantages:

- This will give you significant freedom to choose what to work on.
- It will allow different people to bring and use different levels of experience (e.g. Novice vs Intermediate vs Expert) in appropriate ways.
- Allows for specialization (e.g. You can do 1 Niagara task then something else, or do Niagara every week all term.
- Simplifies grading and allows for simple, in-class check-in to reduce uncertainty.
- Creates incentives for advanced learners to share their knowledge through creating tutorials, presenting work to the class, and mentoring.
- Creates a simple system that can accommodate many different tasks at once.
- Allows for several different kinds of deliverables to be created, playing to different students strengths and preferences.

While we are getting used to the framework, guidelines will be provided as to which tasks to do and on which particular topic. As the project progresses, other types of tasks, as well as greater autonomy over which tasks to do will unlock.

For this assignment, I'll be providing you with a structured observation task, but as we move forward, you'll have more opportunity to branch off into more specific and particular tasks.

Grading Summary

Observation Grading & Rubric

Observation Grading:

Normally, Observation tasks are worth 1 Point, you'll complete multiple tasks per week.

For this first iteration, I've broken down the Observation task into several smaller tasks to help get you started.

When you think you have the task complete and are ready to grade it, you can show the instructor in class or through Teams to confirm it's complete.

You can choose to do them one at a time or in bulk, but will be expected to submit the progress biweekly in the drop box as well. Include a self grading form with that.

Soft Deadline:
Jan 14th - In Class

Hard Deadline / Dropbox
Deadline:
Jan 17th 11:59PM

Dylan

Assigned → Observation Task A: Video Analysis

Observe

Base

1



Observation Task A: Video Analysis:

Record or find game play footage of Dead Cells or other reference platformer games. You will be looking for effective uses of particle systems.

Task Goals:

- ☐ Find at least 5 examples of effective use of particle systems in gameplay footage.
- ☐ Highlight each as a sequence of screenshots or short video clip (e.g. Gif)
- ☐ Write a short summary for each effect that touches on each of the following:
 - ☐ Identify what each effect communicates to the player.
 - ☐ Give a brief description of how the particle works
 - (e.g. *Is it world or local space, make a guess on how you would recreate it in basic terms or describe how it appears. Does it start from a single point or a shape? Is velocity added or removed? What changes over the lifetime of the particle, etc).*
- ☐ Where do you see them being used in our current game?

- ☐ Include the following rankings as a number from 1-5 (*1 = Lowest , 5 = Highest*)
 - **Effectiveness:** Rank each from 1-5 based on effectiveness of communicating to the player. (*1 being least effective, 5 being most effective*)
 - **Relevance:** Rank each effect in terms of relevancy to our current game. (*1 being least relevant, 5 being most relevant*)

Final Deliverables:

- ☐ Add your work to the Shared Modern Tech Figma board and sort each by which game element it is related to (Player, NPCs - Break out individually, Environment, UI, Misc).
- ☐ Demonstrate to the class 1 effect that you thought was the most effective and most relevant. (*Just quickly on the Figma board, you don't need to do a formal presentation*)
- ☐ Export your work as a PDF and submit it to the Dropbox.

Deliverable Types: Figma Notes

Deliverable Example: An exported PDF of your work breaking down the video and explaining the results and conclusions you drew on our Figma board.

Grading Details - Figma Notes

Deliverable Details: Figma

Notes: Research, Code Documentation or Architecture Design

Deliverable Summary:

Approximately one page of text (250 words) & 8-10 Screenshots or other support elements.

Deliverables Guidelines: (DO ALL STEPS)

1. Posted on the public Shared Figma board for marking in class.
2. Briefly present one of your particle systems you highlighted to the class.
3. Submit the exported PDF to the bi-weekly dropbox. *
 - *Note: Don't make these images too big or they are hard to open and read. Do it as a set of PDFs if you need to.*

Grading Details - Content Guidelines

Writing Guidelines:

- Your writing should be clear, formatted, free of grammatical and spelling errors, and demonstrating reasonable paragraph and sentence structure.

Paragraph and Sentence Structure Guidelines:

- Paragraphs are clear and concise.
- Sufficient context is given for the content you are referring to.
- The order of tasks is clear. (if appropriate)
- Additional notes or asides are highlighted in a different color or style.

Format Guidelines:

- Titles and headers are present where appropriate.
- Headers follow a logical hierarchy (e.g. h1 is title with h2 subtitle) in terms of size and visibility.
- Fonts are readable.
- You should have titles and subtitles that give some additional context or draws interest. (*E.G. Game balance in Sidescrollers throughout history*) *not* (*Dylan's Report for Assignment 3*)
- Include your name, course (E.G. GD2) and assignment number (E.G. A1) as well as the date at the top of the document.

Naming Guidelines:

- The PDF should have a reasonable name (e.g GD2_A1_DylanFries.pdf).
- PDF's should NOT be placed in a ZIP (or other type) of archive file.

Grading Details - Rubric

Week 1 - Rubric

This week, you will just be doing a single observation task. This will comprise the first 1/2 of Assignment 1 .

Tasks:

There are 4 Core tasks to complete. Each are worth 1 Point.

- ☐ Find 5 examples
- ☐ Highlight each as a sequence of screenshots or clips
- ☐ Short Summary/Answer Questions
- ☐ Rankings

(Assignment 1 is 15% of the course, so this part (1A) will be worth 7.5% of your total course mark).

Each Task is graded either:

1/1 - Successfully Completed
0.5/1 - Somewhat Successfully Completed
0/1 - Not Completed

Your grade for this part of the assignment will be either:

4 Points ⇒ 10/10 = 100% ⇒ A+
3 Points ⇒ 7/10 = 70% ⇒ B
2 Points ⇒ 6/10 = 60% ⇒ D
1 Point ⇒ 5/10 = 50% ⇒ D
0 Points ⇒ 0/10 = 0 = F

You can check in on Wednesday next week if you want to check your assignment against the guidelines or get feedback.